

About Validation Criteria Standard

Defining the Conditions Against Which Validity Is Judged

Knowing what is being validated is not enough.

Knowing why it is being validated is not enough.

Knowing what validation must cover is not enough.

Validation also requires an explicit basis for judgment.

Validation Criteria Standard (VCRS) is the third Parent Standard of **VALIDOS® — Validation Governance Architecture**, governing how validation requirements, criteria, thresholds, acceptance conditions, rejection conditions, and evaluation boundaries are established before validation methodology and execution begin.

VCRS addresses one fundamental question:

Against which explicit, justified, and governable conditions should the Validation Object be evaluated?

Why Validation Criteria Standard Exists

A validation process can appear rigorous while its underlying criteria remain unclear.

A system may be extensively tested without an explicit definition of what constitutes acceptable performance.

A model may be evaluated against thresholds selected only after results are known.

A claim may be assessed according to standards that were never formally established.

Different evaluators may apply different expectations to the same Validation Object.

In each case, validation activity exists, but the basis for determining validity remains unstable.

VCRS prevents this by establishing a governed **Validation Criteria Framework** before conclusions are reached.

Criteria Before Method

VALIDOS® establishes an important methodological sequence:

First determine what must be demonstrated.

Then determine how it should be examined.

Validation Criteria therefore precede Validation Method.

A criterion defines the condition against which the Validation Object will be evaluated.

A method defines how evidence concerning that condition will be obtained or examined.

These responsibilities must remain separate.

For example:

Criterion: a defined performance threshold must be satisfied.

Method: the statistical, experimental, observational, computational, documentary, expert, or other procedure used to evaluate whether that threshold has been satisfied.

Separating criteria from method allows VALIDOS® to remain methodologically stable even when validation technologies and techniques change.

From Validation Mandate to Validation Criteria

VCRS receives the Validation Mandate established through Validation Purpose & Scope governance.

It transforms:

Purpose + Scope + Depth + Applicability + Limitations

into:

Requirements + Criteria + Thresholds + Acceptance Conditions + Rejection Conditions

The resulting Validation Criteria Framework becomes the evaluation reference for subsequent validation activity.

Criteria Must Be Explicit

Implicit expectations create unstable validation.

A governed criterion should make it possible to determine what characteristic is being evaluated and what condition must be satisfied.

Criteria may originate from:

- operational requirements,
 - safety requirements,
 - performance requirements,
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- integrity requirements,
- regulatory obligations,
- legal requirements,
- contractual requirements,
- scientific knowledge,
- technical specifications,
- domain standards,
- governance requirements,
- risk conditions,
- or other legitimate validation references.

VCRS does not assume that every available requirement automatically becomes a validation criterion.

Its relevance to the approved Validation Purpose and Scope must first be established.

Not All Criteria Are Equal

Different criteria may perform different governance functions.

Some may be mandatory.

Some may apply only under defined conditions.

Some may provide supporting information.

Some may immediately exclude a particular validation outcome.

Others may depend upon several subordinate criteria.

VCRS therefore allows criteria to be classified according to their role within the Validation Criteria Framework.

This prevents materially different validation conditions from being treated as if they carried identical significance.

Thresholds Must Have a Basis

Many validation criteria require a boundary between acceptable and unacceptable conditions.

That boundary may take the form of:

- a minimum value,
- a maximum value,
- a permitted range,
- a tolerance,
- a confidence level,
- an error boundary,
- a categorical state,
- or another defined threshold.

VCRS requires material thresholds to have an identifiable basis.

A threshold should not move merely because the observed result would otherwise fail.

This creates a fundamental governance protection:

The target should not be rewritten after the result is known.

Acceptance Is Not the Same as Validity

Satisfaction of one validation criterion does not necessarily mean that the Validation Object is valid.

A complex validation may contain many criteria.

Some may be satisfied.

Some may fail.

Some may remain unresolved.

Some may be conditional.

VCRS governs the criteria against which those results will later be interpreted.

The final relationship between criterion outcomes and the overall Validation Determination belongs to subsequent VALIDOS® governance.

Failure Is Not the Same as Missing Evidence

VALIDOS® also preserves another important distinction.

A criterion may be:

Satisfied

or:

Not Satisfied

But validation may also be unable to determine satisfaction because:

- evidence is unavailable,
- evidence is insufficient,
- execution is incomplete,
- the source is unreliable,
- uncertainty remains unresolved,
- or a required validation activity could not be performed.

These conditions should not automatically be represented as criterion failure.

VCRS establishes the evaluation condition.

Later VALIDOS® standards determine whether sufficient validated information exists to evaluate it.

Criteria Must Match the Validation Mandate

Validation Criteria cannot exist independently of the Validation Purpose and Scope.

The governing relationship is:

Validation Object → Purpose & Scope → Validation Criteria

If a criterion has no meaningful relationship to the approved Validation Mandate, its role in the validation process requires justification.

If a material part of the Validation Mandate has no corresponding criteria, the validation may be incomplete.

VCRS therefore requires both **criteria relevance** and **criteria completeness**.

Criteria Conflict Must Be Visible

Real validation environments may contain conflicting requirements.

Performance may conflict with safety.

Operational efficiency may conflict with robustness.

Different regulatory frameworks may establish different thresholds.

Scientific references may disagree.

Multiple governance requirements may compete.

VCRS does not assume that these conflicts disappear.

It requires them to become explicit governance objects before they influence validation conclusions.

A validation process should not silently choose whichever criterion produces the preferred outcome.

Criteria Must Remain Stable

Validation becomes unreliable when its evaluation conditions change invisibly during the process.

VCRS therefore treats material criteria changes as governance events.

Where a criterion or threshold changes, the effect on:

Method → Evidence → Execution → Determination

must be considered.

This also means that a historical Validation Determination must remain connected to the criteria version under which it was produced.

Criteria Versioning Matters

A Validation Object may be evaluated today against one Validation Criteria Framework and later against a revised framework.

The object itself may remain unchanged while the applicable validation criteria evolve.

VCRS therefore preserves the question:

Which criteria governed this validation determination?

Without this reference, two apparently identical validation results may represent fundamentally different evaluation conditions.

Criteria Are Not Evidence

A criterion defines what must be established.

Evidence provides information relevant to establishing it.

These concepts must remain separate.

For example:

Criterion: system error must remain below an approved threshold.

Evidence: measured system-performance data.

A large quantity of evidence cannot compensate for an undefined criterion.

Likewise, a perfectly defined criterion cannot produce a reliable determination without adequate evidence.

VALIDOS® governs these responsibilities through separate governance spaces.

Governance Rather Than Technical Testing

VCRS does not prescribe a universal set of criteria for every AI system, organization, model, dataset, decision, simulation, or operational environment.

Different Validation Objects and purposes require different

substantive criteria.

VCRS instead governs **how criteria themselves must be established and controlled.**

This allows the standard to remain technology-neutral and domain-independent while still providing a common validation-governance methodology.

Position Within VALIDOS®

Validation Criteria Standard is the third Parent Standard of **VALIDOS® — Validation Governance Architecture.**

Its architectural position is:

**Validation Object → Validation Purpose & Scope → Validation Criteria
→ Validation Method → Validation Evidence Fitness → Validation
Source Reliability → Validation Execution → Validation Determination
→ Validation State → Validation Reliance & Revalidation**

The first Parent Standard asks:

What exactly are we validating?

The second asks:

Why are we validating it, what must validation cover, and within which limits may it apply?

The third asks:

Against what conditions should validity be judged?

Only after these questions have been answered should VALIDOS® proceed to:

How should those conditions actually be examined?

Relationship to Other OOF® Architectures

VCRS operates alongside complementary OOF® governance architectures.

GOA™ may provide governance requirements, authority conditions, and structural governance references.

INTEGROS® may provide integrity conditions that become relevant validation requirements.

ORA™ may provide operational conditions against which validation criteria must be established.

OBIDENTITY® may provide identity, origin, ownership, provenance, and continuity conditions.

AGA™ may provide accountability and responsibility requirements.

RIS™ may provide risk conditions relevant to validation criteria and thresholds.

AIG®, CLIA®, MGIA™, and **ASGA™** may provide domain-specific governance requirements that can become validation criteria where relevant.

VCRS does not replace those architectures.

It provides the validation-governance mechanism through which relevant requirements can become explicit conditions against which a Validation Object is evaluated.

Why It Matters

Without explicit criteria, validation can become a conclusion searching for justification.

With governed criteria, it becomes possible to determine:

- what was expected,
- why it was expected,
- which threshold applied,
- what constituted acceptance,
- what constituted rejection,
- which criteria were mandatory,
- which conditions were unresolved,
- which criteria version was used,
- and whether the eventual determination actually followed the established evaluation framework.

This makes validation more explainable, comparable, reproducible, auditable, and governable.

Foundational Principle

Validity cannot be governed against criteria that were never explicitly established.

Canonical Closing Statement

Validation Criteria Standard establishes the evaluation-reference layer of VALIDOS® — Validation Governance Architecture. By governing the requirements, criteria, thresholds, acceptance conditions, rejection conditions, dependencies, conflicts, completeness, stability, and versions against which validity is judged, VCRS ensures that validation conclusions emerge from explicit and

traceable evaluation conditions rather than implicit expectations,
changing targets, or post-hoc interpretation.

Parent Resources

→ [VALIDOS® Architecture Map](#)

→ [VALIDOS® Complete Standards & Modules Index](#)

Related Documents

→ [Validation Criteria Standard](#)

→ [VALIDOS® Validation Governance Architecture — Validation Governance Layer](#)

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